

Replication file for

Democracy in America? Partisanship, Polarization, and the Robustness of Support for Democracy in the United States

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Overview

This document is a guide to the replication file it accompanies.

To begin using the replication file, download the full .zip file from the Dataverse and extract everything into the same directory. The replication file consists of three subdirectories: data, scripts, and paper.

About the scripts

All of the data analysis is conducted in R. The scripts are optimized for viewing in RStudio, or another program that automatically treats lines that end in repeated special characters as headers. When all of the sections are collapsed, they function as a table of contents. For example, from figures.R:

```
1 ▸ ### Packages (run once)
16 ▸ ### Environment
42 ▸ ### Datasets
113 ▸ ### Plot styling
192 ▸ ### Figure 2 calculations: group means and difference in means
285 ▸ ### Figure 2 plot
286
287 g1 = plot_voteShare(tab_mean %>% filter(Measure=="Policy Rating", Trar
288                               linesize = .5, dotsize = 1.5, errorbarwidth = .05)
289   scale_x_continuous(breaks = (-5:5)/5, labels = c("-1", "-.8", "-.6",
```

To run each script, begin in the environment section. Set the working directory to your folder by changing the path in setwd("path"). Each script's environment section contains all of the R packages that must be installed to run the entire script.

In the three scripts that analyze the choice experiment (figures.R, structural.R, in text.R), pay attention to the two options that control the block bootstrap functions. From figures.R:

```
23 # script options
24 fresh = F # FALSE: sometimes load pre-calculated results. TRUE: calculate everything
25 Nsim = 1000 # how many bootstrap replicates?
```

If fresh = F, most instances of the block bootstrap function (block_boot()) will not run; instead, pre-calculated results import from paper/results. If fresh = T, the block bootstrap function will run. You can adjust the number of simulations by changing Nsim.

List of scripts

figures.R Produces most figures and tables related to the choice experiment.

Data files: experiment.csv, howDemocratic.csv

structural.R Performs all analysis for the structural estimation section.

	<i>Data files:</i> experiment.csv
in text.R	Produces estimates that appear in the main text and aren't based on a figure. <i>Data files:</i> experiment.csv.
weights.R	Produces weights.csv, the respondent weights used in all analysis. All results can be produced without ever running this script. <i>Data files:</i> demographics.csv, acs_hhi.csv, psam_pusa.csv (external), psam_pusb.csv (external). <i>Instructions for obtaining external files:</i> Find the public use microdata file for the American Community Survey's 2017 1-year estimates at the national level. As of 11/30/19, a .zip file containing both external files was available at https://www2.census.gov/programs-surveys/acs/data/pums/2017/1-Year/csv_pus.zip .
benchmark.R	Creates the table in Appendix A.5. The table compares the sample used in the choice experiment to the 2017 American Community Survey 1-year estimates and the 2016 American National Election Study. <i>Data files:</i> acs_margins.csv, demographics.csv, anes_timeseries_2016_Stata12.dta (external). <i>Instructions for obtaining external files:</i> Visit the ANES data center at electionstudies.org . Download the Stata version of the 2016 Time Series Study.
montana.R	Performs all analysis in the Montana sections of the paper and appendix. <i>Data files:</i> montana.csv, mt_covariates.csv, mt_voterChar_diffs.csv
helpers.R	Functions appearing in multiple scripts.

List of data files

codebook.xlsx	Describes all variables that appear in the next three .csv files listed.
experiment.csv	Contains all data for the choice experiment, including respondent covariates.
demographics.csv	Contains the background variables. Used only in benchmark.R and weights.R. All variables appear in experiment.csv.
howDemocratic.csv	Contains responses to democracy-related questions from wave 1. Used only in figures.R. All variables appear in experiment.csv.
montana.csv	Contains precinct-level vote totals for the analysis of Montana's 2017 special election.
mt_covariates.csv	Contains control variables calculated from the Montana voter file.
mt_voterChar_diffs.csv	Contains the data plotted in appendix figures F.2 and F.3.
mt_full_data.zip	Contains raw data as received, a cleaned .csv file for each county, and a script that merges the county-level files into montana.csv.

nces_data.zip	Contains data and a script to verify our claim in appendix section C.4 that state aid tends to contribute a higher percentage of the budget in lower income school districts.
acs_hhi.csv	Contains household income data used for weighting. All other ACS crosstabs are computed from the ACS public use microdata files (see weights.R and Appendix B).

Note: all files prefixed “key_” are used for labels or recoding in the R scripts.